

SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS
FOR
LPU-10/P MKII or Equivalent Underarm Life Preserver



336 Training Support Squadron

February 2026

**Salient Characteristics
For
LPU-10/P MKII or Equivalent Underarm Life Preserver
Fairchild AFB, WA**

FA462026QA228
Attachment 1 - Salient Characteristics

1. BACKGROUND: Underarm life preservers are required during SERE water survival training for all aircrew that have the ability to perform emergency parachute bailout procedures. Without these life preservers, water survival training will not be able to be performed. SERE water survival instruction syllabus S-V85-A states LPU-10/P life preserver or asset that simulates both physical and operational characteristics of the student's assigned or projected weapon system AFE. These life preservers are utilized to keep students afloat when submerged in pool or open ocean water scenarios to train on emergency bail out procedures. They have to mirror operational assets, so they are trained on utilization of all aspects of the equipment (oral inflation tubes, Velcro attachment points, harness adjustment etc.)

2. OBJECTIVES: The objective is to obtain a suitable stock of life preservers to be utilized during water survival training, as well as a back stock of replacement parts for periodic maintenance and repair of assets. Life preservers used during water survival training are often damaged due to the high use of emergency assets designed for one time use being utilized on a weekly basis. The objective is to graduate aircrew students for the USAF. Without these life preservers, aircrew students are unable to complete required pilot training pipeline water survival course and will halt aircrew from progressing into the operational force.

3. REQUIREMENTS: The contractor needs to provide a life preserver with the following characteristics:

- Deploys under the arms to avoid interference with parachute risers during emergency aircraft bailout
- Mounts to an adjustable torso harness secured by a single chest-buckle assembly with a one size fits all size. Must have adjustable shoulder straps.
- Requires manual activation only (no automatic or water-sensing activation)
- Each cell must include its own oral inflation capability
- Cells must inflate independently
- Must be repackable and suitable for multiple uses
- Must provide a minimum of 80 pounds of buoyancy
- Must have a way to connect the two cells in front of the user while inflated

4. PARTS LIST:

NSN/PART NUMBER	DESCRIPTION	QUANTITY
NSN: 4220-01-705-8648	Underarm Life Preserver	150